

GOVERNMENT HACK™

Unit Assessment Book

Unit 7 — Tennessee State and Local Government · Teacher Edition

HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

Three parts: (1) Formative Checkpoints — a short check per standard for progress monitoring (MTSS); (2) Unit Summative — two parallel forms (A and B) for pre/post or retakes; (3) Teacher Answer Key + Item Analysis + Reteach.

All items are pulled from the Government Hack question bank. Assessment items are classroom-formative · pre-field-test.

Administering these forms is what generates the response data to CALIBRATE the pre-calibrated items — the first cycle of use closes the loop.

Keys and reteach live in this teacher book only — reproduce the student sections (formative + Form A/B) without the key section.

Contents

Part 1 — Formative Checkpoints (by standard)

A quick DOK-balanced check for each standard. Use for progress monitoring; reteach routing is in the Teacher Key.

GC.28 — Tennessee's Three Branches

1. Under the 'Tennessee Plan,' how do the state's appellate judges reach the bench? [GC.28 · DOK 2 · pre-field-test]

- A. The governor appoints them, and they then face yes-or-no retention elections
- B. They are chosen in contested partisan elections statewide
- C. They are appointed by the President and confirmed by the U.S. Senate
- D. They inherit their seats and serve for life without any election

GC.29 — Local Government in Tennessee

1. Because Tennessee is a unitary state, its county and city governments — [GC.29 · DOK 2 · pre-field-test]

- A. are completely independent of the state government
- B. hold only the powers that the state grants them
- C. report directly to the federal government
- D. may set aside state law within their own borders

GC.30 — Identify Your Current Officials

1. The Tennessee General Assembly is made up of which two chambers? [GC.30 · DOK 1 · pre-field-test]

- A. a Cabinet and a Supreme Court
- B. a House of Lords and a House of Commons
- C. a Senate and a House of Representatives
- D. the Grand Divisions and the counties

Part 2 — Unit Summative · Form A

DIRECTIONS

Choose the best answer for each question. Assessment items are classroom-formative · pre-field-test.

Name: _____ Class / Period: _____ Date: _____

1. A Tennessean files a lawsuit seeking an injunction and asks a court of equity to resolve a property dispute. In Tennessee's trial-court system, which court hears matters of equity and is presided over by a Chancellor? [GC.28 · DOK 2 · pre-field-test]

- A. Criminal Court
- B. Chancery Court
- C. Circuit Court
- D. U.S. District Court

2. A Tennessee city wants to create a new tax that state law does not authorize. Based on Dillon's Rule, what is the most likely legal outcome? [GC.29 · DOK 3 · pre-field-test]

- A. The city may impose it because cities are sovereign governments
- B. The federal government must approve the new tax first
- C. The city cannot impose it, because local governments hold only the powers the state grants
- D. The tax becomes legal automatically once local voters approve it

3. In the Tennessee General Assembly, how is each individual Tennessean represented? [GC.30 · DOK 2 · pre-field-test]

- A. by one state senator and one state representative, based on where the person lives
- B. by two state senators and one state representative
- C. by one state senator only, with no representative
- D. by all 33 senators and all 99 representatives equally

Part 3 — Unit Summative · Form B

DIRECTIONS

Choose the best answer for each question. Assessment items are classroom-formative · pre-field-test.

Name: _____ Class / Period: _____ Date: _____

1. Tennessee copied the federal three-branch design but added its own features: the Grand Divisions, a part-time citizen legislature, and the Tennessee Plan. What do these three features have in common? [GC.28 · DOK 3 · pre-field-test]

- A. Each was required by the U.S. Constitution
- B. Each concerns only city and county government
- C. Each is a distinctive feature of Tennessee's own constitution and government, not the federal model
- D. Each was created by an act of the U.S. Congress

2. A government that merges a city with its surrounding county into a single consolidated unit is called a — [GC.29 · DOK 2 · pre-field-test]

- A. metropolitan government
- B. county commission
- C. unitary state
- D. Grand Division

3. To identify the state senator and state representative who currently represent you, which is the most reliable source? [GC.30 · DOK 1 · pre-field-test]

- A. a claim shared on social media
- B. the official 'Find My Legislator' tool on the Tennessee General Assembly site (capitol.tn.gov)
- C. a textbook printed several years ago
- D. a friend's best guess

Part 4 — Teacher Answer Key + Item Analysis + Reteach

READING THE ANALYSIS

Each item shows its standard, DOK, correct key, and TCAP reporting category, plus a reteach move. Distractor-based routing: a wrong choice signals which idea to reteach — pair with the workbook Cornell notes and Guided Support. Assessment items are classroom-formative · pre-field-test.

Form A — key & reteach

Item	Standard	DOK	Key	Reporting cat.	What's Next if missed (reteach)
1	GC.28	2	B	RC-GOV7: Tennessee State and Local Government	Revisit Tennessee's Three Branches — Cornell cues + Guided Support; re-check with the Exit Ticket.
2	GC.29	3	C	RC-GOV7: Tennessee State and Local Government	Revisit Local Government in Tennessee — Cornell cues + Guided Support; re-check with the Exit Ticket.
3	GC.30	2	A	RC-GOV7: Tennessee State and Local Government	Revisit Identify Your Current Officials — Cornell cues + Guided Support; re-check with the Exit Ticket.

Form B — key & reteach

Item	Standard	DOK	Key	Reporting cat.	What's Next if missed (reteach)
1	GC.28	3	C	RC-GOV7: Tennessee State and Local Government	Revisit Tennessee's Three Branches — Cornell cues + Guided Support; re-check with the Exit Ticket.
2	GC.29	2	A	RC-GOV7: Tennessee State and Local Government	Revisit Local Government in Tennessee — Cornell cues + Guided Support; re-check with the Exit Ticket.
3	GC.30	1	B	RC-GOV7: Tennessee State and Local Government	Revisit Identify Your Current Officials — Cornell cues + Guided Support; re-check with the Exit Ticket.

Formative Checkpoints — key & reteach

Item	Standard	DOK	Key	Reporting cat.	What's Next if missed (reteach)
1	GC.28	2	A	RC-GOV7: Tennessee State and Local Government	Revisit Tennessee's Three Branches — Cornell cues + Guided Support; re-check with the Exit Ticket.
2	GC.29	2	B	RC-GOV7: Tennessee State and Local Government	Revisit Local Government in Tennessee — Cornell cues + Guided Support; re-check with the Exit Ticket.

Item	Standard	DOK	Key	Reporting cat.	What's Next if missed (reteach)
3	GC.30	1	C	RC-GOV7: Tennessee State and Local Government	Revisit Identify Your Current Officials — Cornell cues + Guided Support; re-check with the Exit Ticket.

Part 5 — Psychometric Blueprint (Teacher)

ABOUT THESE NUMBERS

Every item carries a cognitive-rigor classification (Webb's DOK × Bloom's, located on the Hess Cognitive Rigor Matrix) and a pre-calibration IRT 3PL estimate: a = discrimination, b = difficulty, c = pseudo-guessing.

These IRT parameters are DESIGN-TIME ESTIMATES, not empirical calibrations. IRT 3PL parameters are pre-field-test design-time estimates, to be calibrated on field-test data. Assessment items are classroom-formative · pre-field-test.

Distractor codes: PK prior-knowledge · MC misconception · PE partial evidence · NE nearby error · CA causal attribution · AN anachronism · OG overgeneralization.

BANK DISTRIBUTION

DOK: 1: 2 · 2: 5 · 3: 2

Bloom's: Understand: 5 · Remember: 2 · Apply: 1 · Analyze: 1

Mean discrimination a ≈ 1.3 · Mean difficulty b ≈ 0.033

Field-test-ready items: 9 of 9

Form A — item psychometrics

Item	Std	DOK	Bloom's (Hess cell)	a	b	c	C3	FT?	Distractor codes
1	GC.28	2	Understand × DOK 2	1.3	0.3	0.2	D2	Y	A:NE C:NE D:PK
2	GC.29	3	Apply × DOK 3	1.6	0.9	0.2	D2	Y	A:MC B:PK D:PE
3	GC.30	2	Understand × DOK 2	1.3	0.1	0.2	D2	Y	B:NE C:PE D:MC

Form B — item psychometrics

Item	Std	DOK	Bloom's (Hess cell)	a	b	c	C3	FT?	Distractor codes
1	GC.28	3	Analyze × DOK 3	1.6	1	0.2	D2	Y	A:MC B:NE D:PK
2	GC.29	2	Understand × DOK 2	1.2	0	0.2	D2	Y	B:NE C:PK D:PK
3	GC.30	1	Remember × DOK 1	1.1	-1	0.2	D2	Y	A:MC C:NE D:MC

Formative — item psychometrics

Item	Std	DOK	Bloom's (Hess cell)	a	b	c	C3	FT?	Distractor codes
1	GC.28	2	Understand × DOK 2	1.3	0.2	0.2	D2	Y	B:NE C:PK D:MC
2	GC.29	2	Understand × DOK 2	1.3	0.1	0.2	D2	Y	A:MC C:PK D:MC
3	GC.30	1	Remember × DOK 1	1	-1.3	0.2	D2	Y	A:PK B:AN D:PK

Part 6 — UDL Supports & Remediation (Teacher)

UNIVERSAL DESIGN FOR LEARNING (UDL 3.0) SUPPORTS — APPLIES TO EVERY ITEM

These supports vary the MEANS of access, not the mastery target. They apply to every item on the formative checkpoints and both summative forms.

Representation — CAST 3.0 Rep — key terms glossed (EN/ES); read-aloud on request; large-print/screen-reader friendly

Action & Expression — [MC] respond by selecting/pointing/AT · [open] respond in writing, speech, or a labeled diagram; word processor/speech-to-text available

Engagement — action-oriented feedback via the remediation routing; DOK-tiered challenge

Supports vary the means, not the mastery target — UDL design, not modification. CAST (2024). Universal Design for Learning Guidelines version 3.0.

HOW TO USE THIS SECTION

For each item: if a student misses it, start with the If-missed reteach, then route by the SPECIFIC wrong choice the student picked (each distractor signals a distinct misconception), and escalate through MTSS Tier 2 → Tier 3 if the misconception persists across parallel forms. Assessment items are classroom-formative · pre-field-test.

Form A — UDL & distractor-based remediation

Item 1 — GC.28 · DOK 2

If missed: Revisit “Tennessee's Three Branches” using the unit's Cornell notes + the standard's graphic organizer; re-check with the Exit Ticket, then re-assess with a parallel-form item.

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
A	Right court system but wrong court; Criminal Court handles felonies, not equity.	contrast the near-miss with the precise answer
C	Circuit Court hears general civil and criminal trials, not specifically equity.	contrast the near-miss with the precise answer
D	Confuses a state court with a federal court.	clarify the boundary with the confused concept

MTSS ROUTING

Tier 2 — Small-group (Tier 2) reteach targeting the signaled misconception (10–15 min, organizer + worked example), then re-assess with a parallel item.

Tier 3 — If it persists across parallel forms (Tier 3): intensive 1:1 with concrete→representational→abstract scaffolding + think-aloud; progress-monitor weekly toward the same standard.

Item 2 — GC.29 · DOK 3

If missed: Revisit “Local Government in Tennessee” using the unit's Cornell notes + the standard's graphic organizer; re-check with the Exit Ticket, then re-assess with a parallel-form item.

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
A	Contradicts Dillon's Rule; localities are not sovereign in a unitary state.	confront the misconception with a worked counter-example
B	Confuses federal and state authority; state law, not federal approval, governs local taxing.	clarify the boundary with the confused concept
D	Uses a partly-true idea (voter approval) but ignores that the state must first authorize the tax.	model carrying partial evidence to the correct conclusion

MTSS ROUTING

Tier 2 — Small-group (Tier 2) reteach targeting the signaled misconception (10–15 min, organizer + worked example), then re-assess with a parallel item.

Tier 3 — If it persists across parallel forms (Tier 3): intensive 1:1 with concrete→representational→abstract scaffolding + think-aloud; progress-monitor weekly toward the same standard.

Item 3 — GC.30 · DOK 2

If missed: Revisit “Identify Your Current Officials” using the unit's Cornell notes + the standard's graphic organizer; re-check with the Exit Ticket, then re-assess with a parallel-form item.

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
B	Right idea, wrong count; each person has one senator, not two.	contrast the near-miss with the precise answer
C	Partly true (one senator) but omits the one representative each person also has.	model carrying partial evidence to the correct conclusion
D	Misconception about representation; a person is represented by their own district's two legislators, not the whole body.	confront the misconception with a worked counter-example

MTSS ROUTING

Tier 2 — Small-group (Tier 2) reteach targeting the signaled misconception (10–15 min, organizer + worked example), then re-assess with a parallel item.

Tier 3 — If it persists across parallel forms (Tier 3): intensive 1:1 with concrete→representational→abstract scaffolding + think-aloud; progress-monitor weekly toward the same standard.

Form B — UDL & distractor-based remediation**Item 1 — GC.28 · DOK 3**

If missed: Revisit “Tennessee's Three Branches” using the unit's Cornell notes + the standard's graphic organizer; re-check with the Exit Ticket, then re-assess with a parallel-form item.

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
A	The U.S. Constitution does not require these state-specific features.	confront the misconception with a worked counter-example
B	Right subject area but wrong scope; these are state-level, not only local, features.	contrast the near-miss with the precise answer

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
D	Confuses federal and state authorship; these come from Tennessee law, not Congress.	clarify the boundary with the confused concept

MTSS ROUTING

Tier 2 — Small-group (Tier 2) reteach targeting the signaled misconception (10-15 min, organizer + worked example), then re-assess with a parallel item.

Tier 3 — If it persists across parallel forms (Tier 3): intensive 1:1 with concrete→representational→abstract scaffolding + think-aloud; progress-monitor weekly toward the same standard.

Item 2 — GC.29 · DOK 2

If missed: Revisit “Local Government in Tennessee” using the unit's Cornell notes + the standard's graphic organizer; re-check with the Exit Ticket, then re-assess with a parallel-form item.

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
B	A county commission is a county's legislative body, not a merged city-county unit.	contrast the near-miss with the precise answer
C	A unitary state describes the state-local power relationship, not a merged local government.	clarify the boundary with the confused concept
D	A Grand Division is a region of the state, not a form of local government.	clarify the boundary with the confused concept

MTSS ROUTING

Tier 2 — Small-group (Tier 2) reteach targeting the signaled misconception (10-15 min, organizer + worked example), then re-assess with a parallel item.

Tier 3 — If it persists across parallel forms (Tier 3): intensive 1:1 with concrete→representational→abstract scaffolding + think-aloud; progress-monitor weekly toward the same standard.

Item 3 — GC.30 · DOK 1

If missed: Revisit “Identify Your Current Officials” using the unit's Cornell notes + the standard's graphic organizer; re-check with the Exit Ticket, then re-assess with a parallel-form item.

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
A	Social media is unverified and unreliable for current officeholders.	confront the misconception with a worked counter-example
C	An old textbook may be outdated because officeholders change with elections.	contrast the near-miss with the precise answer
D	A guess is not an authoritative or reliable source.	confront the misconception with a worked counter-example

MTSS ROUTING

Tier 2 — Small-group (Tier 2) reteach targeting the signaled misconception (10-15 min, organizer + worked example), then re-assess with a parallel item.

Tier 3 — If it persists across parallel forms (Tier 3): intensive 1:1 with concrete→representational→abstract scaffolding + think-aloud; progress-monitor weekly toward the same standard.

Formative Checkpoints — UDL & distractor-based remediation

Item 1 — GC.28 · DOK 2

If missed: Revisit “Tennessee's Three Branches” using the unit's Cornell notes + the standard's graphic organizer; re-check with the Exit Ticket, then re-assess with a parallel-form item.

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
B	Right topic (judicial selection) but wrong method; the Tennessee Plan uses retention, not partisan races.	contrast the near-miss with the precise answer
C	Confuses state selection with the federal appointment process.	clarify the boundary with the confused concept
D	Misconception that appellate judges never face voters; they face retention elections.	confront the misconception with a worked counter-example

MTSS ROUTING

Tier 2 — Small-group (Tier 2) reteach targeting the signaled misconception (10–15 min, organizer + worked example), then re-assess with a parallel item.

Tier 3 — If it persists across parallel forms (Tier 3): intensive 1:1 with concrete→representational→abstract scaffolding + think-aloud; progress-monitor weekly toward the same standard.

Item 2 — GC.29 · DOK 2

If missed: Revisit “Local Government in Tennessee” using the unit's Cornell notes + the standard's graphic organizer; re-check with the Exit Ticket, then re-assess with a parallel-form item.

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
A	Contradicts a unitary system; local governments are creatures of the state, not independent.	confront the misconception with a worked counter-example
C	Confuses federalism levels; local governments answer to the state, not directly to Washington.	clarify the boundary with the confused concept
D	Misconception that localities can override state law; Dillon's Rule forbids this.	confront the misconception with a worked counter-example

MTSS ROUTING

Tier 2 — Small-group (Tier 2) reteach targeting the signaled misconception (10–15 min, organizer + worked example), then re-assess with a parallel item.

Tier 3 — If it persists across parallel forms (Tier 3): intensive 1:1 with concrete→representational→abstract scaffolding + think-aloud; progress-monitor weekly toward the same standard.

Item 3 — GC.30 · DOK 1

If missed: Revisit “Identify Your Current Officials” using the unit's Cornell notes + the standard's graphic organizer; re-check with the Exit Ticket, then re-assess with a parallel-form item.

Wrong choice	Signals misconception	Targeted reteach
A	Confuses legislative chambers with executive and judicial bodies.	clarify the boundary with the confused concept
B	Anachronism importing the British Parliament's chambers into Tennessee.	place events on a timeline
D	Confuses the legislature's chambers with geographic and local divisions.	clarify the boundary with the confused concept

MTSS ROUTING

Tier 2 — Small-group (Tier 2) reteach targeting the signaled misconception (10–15 min, organizer + worked example), then re-assess with a parallel item.

Tier 3 — If it persists across parallel forms (Tier 3): intensive 1:1 with concrete→representational→abstract scaffolding + think-aloud; progress-monitor weekly toward the same standard.